Practical 2: Build a Grouped RetailPulse Sales List Report

Related topic: Create List Reports

Objective

Construct a list report, group it meaningfully, format its columns, and add a summarizing footer.

Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Sales package, the report from Practical 1 (optional starting point).

Step-by-step procedure

1. Create a new **List** report against the RetailPulse Sales package.
2. Add **Region, Store Name, Product Category, Quantity, Sales Amount** as columns.
3. Select Region, then Ctrl-click Store Name, and choose **Group/Ungroup** to build a two-level hierarchy (Region > Store Name).
4. Select Sales Amount: set **Data Format > Currency**. Select Quantity and Sales Amount and set **Horizontal alignment: Right**.
5. Select the Sales Amount column and click **Summarize > Total** so a footer total is created for each group (and overall).
6. From the Toolbox, drag a **Block/Text item** and **Date** into the **Page header** (or Page > Page Header), enter the report title and today's run date, then **Run** and **Save**.

Expected output (illustrative)

RetailPulse – Sales by Region and Store Run date: 06 October 2026

Region	Store Name	Product Category	Quantity	Sales Amount
East	Boston Central	Electronics	310	$186,000
		Apparel	540	$43,200
		Home & Garden	220	$30,800
		Grocery	1,250	$31,250
	Total Boston Central		**2,320**	**$291,250**
	NYC Midtown	Electronics	405	$243,000
		Apparel	610	$51,850
		Home & Garden	185	$27,750
		Grocery	1,480	$37,000
	Total NYC Midtown		**2,680**	**$359,600**
North	Chicago Loop	Electronics	350	$210,000
		Apparel	500	$40,000
		Home & Garden	260	$36,400
		Grocery	1,320	$33,000
	Total Chicago Loop		**2,430**	**$319,400**
	Minneapolis Mall	Electronics	280	$168,000
		Apparel	455	$36,400
		Home & Garden	240	$33,600
		Grocery	1,100	$27,500
	Total Minneapolis Mall		**2,075**	**$265,500**
Overall Total (all regions)			**19,345**	**$2,494,250**

Mock-up: Region bands containing nested Store bands; duplicates collapsed; currency format; right-aligned numbers; per-store totals. West and South regions follow on later pages.

Expected outcome
Rows grouped by Region and Store Name with duplicates collapsed; Sales Amount in currency format and right-aligned; each store total equals the sum of its rows; the page header (title + date) appears on every page.